

HSE TOOLBOX TALK

PORTABLE GENERATOR SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Prevent electric shock, carbon monoxide exposure, fire and fuel hazards during portable generator use.

KEY HAZARDS

1  Electric shock.	2  Carbon monoxide.	3  Fuel fire.	4  Hot surfaces.
5  Damaged cables.	6  Incorrect grounding.	7  Water exposure.	8  Noise.

CRITICAL POINTS TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

01 Electric shock.	02 Carbon monoxide.	03 Fuel fire.
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REMEMBER — SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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PORTABLE GENERATOR SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

FIELD REQUIREMENTS AND VERIFICATION

Prevent electric shock, carbon monoxide exposure, fire and fuel hazards during portable generator use.

SERNEM FIELD 01
FIELD VERIFICATION 1
Location suitable

SERNEM FIELD 02
FIELD VERIFICATION 2
Ventilation adequate

SERNEM FIELD 03
FIELD VERIFICATION 3
Grounding suitable

SERNEM FIELD 04
FIELD VERIFICATION 4
RCD installed

VERIFICATION BEFORE START

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Location suitable | ☐ Ventilation adequate |
| ☐ Grounding suitable | ☐ RCD installed |
| ☐ Cables sound | ☐ Water controlled |

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- Where will the generator be located?
- Is grounding suitable?
- Is RCD protection installed?

FIELD APPLICATION



Portable generators create both electrical and combustion hazards.

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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES

1. ELIMINATE / REDUCE THE RISK

Position generators outdoors with ventilation. • Protect equipment from water. • Direct exhaust away from workers.

2. ENGINEERING & PHYSICAL CONTROLS

Verify grounding requirements. • Stop and cool the engine before refuelling. • Apply hearing protection.

3. WORK METHOD & FIELD CONTROLS

Use RCD/GFCI protection. • Store fuel in approved containers.

4. PPE, VERIFICATION & SUPERVISION

Inspect electrical leads. • Provide fire extinguishers.

CRITICAL WARNING



Team, a generator is not just a power source. We will control exhaust and carbon-monoxide exposure, verify electrical protection, keep fuel away from hot equipment and position the unit safely away from occupied areas.

SITE CHECKLIST — BEFORE STARTING WORK

- ☐ Location suitable
- ☐ Grounding suitable
- ☐ Cables sound
- ☐ Fuel safe
- ☐ Exhaust safe
- ☐ Ventilation adequate
- ☐ RCD installed
- ☐ Water controlled
- ☐ Extinguisher available
- ☐ Crew briefed

